

KF Mini-Meeting Lesson 25

--"MINI-MEETING" FORMAT-- (20 min)

I - MINDFULLNESS (4 min)

-ANB (1 min)

-3 Minute Breathing Space (3 min)

II - CHECK-IN (10 min)

-KF Member "A" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

-KF Member "B" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

III - KF MEETING "PREVIEW" (6 min)

-Bible Teaching -- selected excerpt of previous week KF Bible teaching (5 min)

-Ending Prayer (1 min)

BIBLE TEACHING

This month our focus is on KF Confession 6:

We chose to foster illusions to save the life of our Idol Self.

During this lesson, we will spend a little time talking about the *hope of the glory of God*. We were given an imagination for a reason; imagination is the instrument of hope. By using our imagination, we can envision an oriented, glorious life—a life that co-relates or correlates with the reality of who God is; a life that demonstrates and displays the character of God so that as He is, so are we in this world. We can also imagine the real destructive consequences of refusing to develop that glorious life. Those consequences are briefly summarized in the first chapter of Romans. Our desire to avoid those consequences can be a powerful incentive to choose orientation when events trigger our hotspots. The vision of real glory is like a beacon that guides the lifeboat of our True Self out of chaos and into the light of our potential in Christ.

Let's look at **Romans 5:2** in Nancy's translation.

Through Jesus we had an introduction to this karis relationship in which we stand; and we exult in hope of the glory of God. *(Repeat)*

Do you wonder what *exult* means? It means *to show or feel a lively or triumphant joy; to be highly elated or jubilant*. That is how Christians are supposed to feel about the hope of the glory of God. Isn't that interesting?

What is glory? Glory is the expression of the true character of something wonderful. That expression is then observed by others who add to the glory by appreciating and praising what they see. A good reputation is glorious. In the Bible, glory is often described as light and can be understood as pure radiant energy, unfettered by misorientation. We cannot see our own glory, but as children of light we shine with a radiant energy and express a quality that can be seen by others.

When we do the **TAT** exercise, we are asked to imagine our life without our problem. We imagine what a life of consistent peace might be like. We recall the Believe It Path. We imagine how we might have acted in a healthier manner and, perhaps how we might have allowed another person space to grow. We might also imagine what it is like to live in another person's shoes. That is called *empathy*. When we use our imagination as God intended, we are living in the hope that as we continue our work, we will be able to increasingly express the character of God and the quality of our design. This is the hope of the glory of God, and it is the glory that God intends for each one of us. This glory is not legalistic perfection; it is active, productive, vital growth.

The Idol has a hope, too. It hopes to actualize its illusions. We were designed to be glorious, but the Idol switched the track of that glorious design and shunted our God-given express train onto a side rail of imagined glory leading nowhere. God intended our imagination to be harnessed for exploration and development, and for contributing to our community. But the Idol hijacks and enslaves our beautiful imagination to foster illusions about ourselves, others, and the future—and even to rewrite the past. By abusing the power of this great gift, the Idol distorts reality, denying or ignoring real evidence, and transports us into a fantasy world where we can escape what is true. Our amazing, God-designed imagination is also mercilessly used by the Idol to punish us with anxieties about ourselves and life, and to lash us with self-torment. Our imagination then serves the *hope of the Glory of Me*, and we use it to manufacture a confidence in our own prideful judgments and to glorify our paltry, egocentric achievements. Our hope is that the Idol Self will be glorified, perfected and actualized in the real world.

Whenever you start a thought with “If only,” you are living in the *hope of the Glory of Me*. For example, you might think, “If only I hadn't done that, or if only they would do this. If only I had other parents, genetics, other bosses, another home, or another spouse or body. If only I was gifted with his looks, her talent, his brains, her opportunities, then wouldn't I be glorious?”

But God's hope for you is the development of the core strength of love which casts out all fear wherever and in whatever situation you find yourself. God has a thousand ideas for your future, all of which will delight and stretch you at the same time. He is not just looking to please you. His great hope is that you will fulfill your glorious potential and co-labor with Him to rescue this sorry, messed-up world.

Our prayer might go something like this:

Father, show me Your vision for me today. (Repeat)

Take a deep breath.

ENDING PRAYER

Dear Father and Creator,

Thank You for this time together to train and heal. Hold us in the patterns of this new understanding as You guide us to our glory and to the truth. Lead us to the next step in our healing this week as we co-labor with You to reorient our lives to a more effective flow and to growing our connection with our True Self and mission, with our community and the rest of Creation, and with You, for the glory and honor of our Lord Jesus. Amen.

Take a deep breath.